

RYAN BAXTER-KING

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of Nevada, Reno

2025 - present

Assistant Professor of Political Science

Vanderbilt University

2024 - 2025

Predoctoral Fellow, Center for the Study of Democratic Institutions

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles

2019 - 2025

Ph.D. Political Science

Dissertation: *The Effect of Real-World Events on Political Behavior*

Committee: Lynn Vavreck (Chair), Graeme Blair, Jeffrey Lewis, Chris Tausanovitch, Dan Thompson

Subfields: American Politics and Quantitative Methods

University of California, Los Angeles

2022

M.A. Political Science

Haverford College

2016

B.A. Political Science and Economics (Honors)

Minor: Statistics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political learning, focusing events, electoral accountability, political behavior, public opinion, information environments, media attention, public policy, public health
causal inference, experiments, data science, natural language processing

PUBLISHED ARTICLES

[“Gun-Related Beliefs as Predictors of Gun Policy Support: Findings from the Nationally Representative GRIP Survey,”](#) Julie A. Ward, [Ryan Baxter-King](#), Phillip N. Smith, Krista R. Mehari. *Prevention Science* 2026

[“Local Partisan Context and Mental Health,”](#) [Ryan Baxter-King](#), Jacob Brown, Ryan Enos, Arash Naeim, and Lynn Vavreck. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 2026.

[“Endorsements vs. Information: Experimental Evidence of Backlash and Parallel Persuasion during the COVID-19 Public Health Crisis,”](#) [Ryan Baxter-King](#), Alexander Coppock, Graham Straus, and Lynn Vavreck. *PNAS Nexus* 2025.

[“Perceptions of COVID-19 Risk: How Did People Adapt to the Novel Risk?”](#) Karen Sepucha, Aaron Rudkin, [Ryan Baxter-King](#), Annette L Stanton, Neil Wenger, Lynn Vavreck, Arash Naeim. *Medical Decision Making* 2024.

[“Parental intentions to vaccinate children against COVID-19: Findings from a US National Survey.”](#) Rebecca J Guerin, Arash Naeim, [Ryan Baxter-King](#), Andrea H Okun, Derek Holliday, Lynn Vavreck. *Vaccine* 2023.

[“Strategies to increase the intention to get vaccinated against COVID-19: Findings from a nationally representative survey of US adults, October 2020 to October 2021.”](#) Arash Naeim, Rebecca J Guerin, Ryan Baxter-King, Andrea H Okun, Neil Wenger, Karen Sepucha, Annette L Stanton, Aaron Rudkin, Derek Holliday, Alexander Rossell Hayes, Lynn Vavreck. *Vaccine* 2022.

[“How Local Partisan Context Conditions Pro-Social Behaviors: Mask Wearing During COVID-19.”](#) Ryan Baxter-King, Jacob R. Brown, Ryan D. Enos, Arash Naeim, and Lynn Vavreck. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 2022.

[“Depressive Symptoms and Anxiety During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Large, Longitudinal, Cross-sectional Survey”](#) James J. MacDonald, Ryan Baxter-King, Lynn Vavreck, Arash Naeim, Neil Wenger, Karen Sepucha, Annette L Stanton. *JMIR Mental Health* 2022.

[“The Impact of COVID-19 on Routine Medical Care and Cancer Screening.”](#) Neil S. Wenger, Annette L. Stanton, Ryan Baxter-King, Karen Sepucha, Lynn Vavreck, and Arash Naeim. *Journal of General Internal Medicine* 2022.

[“Effects of Age, Gender, Health Status, and Political Party on COVID-19–Related Concerns and Prevention Behaviors: Results of a Large, Longitudinal Cross-sectional Survey.”](#) Arash Naeim, Ryan Baxter-King, Neil Wenger, Annette Stanton, Karen Sepucha, and Lynn Vavreck. *JMIR Public Health Surveillance* 2021.

[“Effect of a predictive model on planned surgical duration accuracy, patient wait time and use of pre-surgical resources: a randomized controlled trial.”](#) Christopher Strömblad, Ryan Baxter-King, Amirhossein Meisami, Shok-Jean Yee, Marcia R. Levine, Aaron Ostrovsky, Daniel Stein, Alexia Iasonos, Martin R. Weiser, Julio Garcia-Aguilar, Nadeem R. Abu-Rustum, Roger S. Wilson. *JAMA Surgery* 2021.

[“Fatalities from COVID-19 are reducing Americans’ support for Republicans at every level of federal office.”](#) Christopher Warshaw, Lynn Vavreck, and Ryan Baxter-King. *Science Advances* 2020.

WORKING PAPERS

[“The Effect of Real-World Events on Political Attitudes and Preference Intensity: Evidence from Mass Shootings.”](#) (*Funded by the Rapoport Family Foundation.*)

[“Country Over Party: When Social Identity Strengthens Democratic Accountability”](#)
(*with Brian Hamel and Moriah Harman, Presented at MPSA 2026*)

[“Following Which Leader? Endorsements by Public Officials Affect Support for COVID-19 Restrictions”](#) (*with Derek Holliday*)

[“Proximate Events and Political Socialization: Evidence from Mass Shootings”](#)
(*Presented at MPSA 2026, APSA 2026, UNR Faculty Seminar 2025. Draft available on request.*)

[“Does the Spotlight Last? Policy Coverage in Local Newspapers After Mass Shootings”](#)
(*Presented at APPAM 2025, UNR Faculty Seminar 2026.*)

[“Does Information About the Health Effects of Anti-Transgender Laws Affect Political Attitudes?”](#)
(*Presented at MPSA 2026. Draft available on request.*)

PROFESSIONAL CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2023 - 2026
Society of Political Methodology Annual Meeting	2024, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2022, 2024 - 2026
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management	2025 - 2026
Western Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2021

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

VPRI Travel Grant (\$1,000), UNR	2026
VPRI Seed Grant (\$2,841), UNR	2025
VPRI Dimensions Grant (\$2,000), UNR	2025
Nominee for The Andrew Carnegie Fellows Program, UNR (<i>The University's Single Nominee for Untenured Fellowship</i>)	2025
Doctoral Dissertation Grant(\$15,000), Rapoport Family Foundation	2024
Political Psychology Fellowship (\$2,000), UCLA	2024
Dissertation Year Award, UCLA	2024 - 2025
Political Psychology Fellowship, UCLA	2022
Graduate Research Mentorship Program, UCLA	2022 - 2023
Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Program, UCLA	2022
Graduate Research Mentorship Program, UCLA	2020 - 2021
Graduate Dean's Scholar Award, UCLA	2019 - 2021
First Year Fellowship, UCLA	2019 - 2020

TEACHING

Advanced Research Methods in Political Science (PSC 782)	F2026
University of Nevada, Reno - PhD students (Link to Syllabus)	
Public Administration Analytics (PSC 780)	F2026
University of Nevada, Reno - MPA students (Link to Syllabus)	
Introduction to American Politics (PSC 101)	F2025, S2026
University of Nevada, Reno - Undergraduate students	
Public Opinion and Political Behavior (PSC 401F/601F)	F2025
University of Nevada, Reno - Undergraduate and PhD students	
Health, Politics, and Culture: Medicare and Medicaid in the 1960s	S2022, S2024
UCLA - Undergraduate students	
America in the 60s (UCLA, Teaching Assistant)	F2023, W2024
UCLA - Undergraduate students (Teaching Assistant)	

SERVICE

Graduate Committee (Member) , Department of Political Science, UNR	2026 – present
Search Committee (Member) , Search for Teaching Assistant Professor in American Politics, Department of Political Science, UNR	
Reviewer , Journal of Politics, Political Behavior	2026
External Grant Reviewer , Russell Sage Foundation	2025, 2026
Communications Liaison , Department of Political Science, UNR	2025 – Present
UNR Reviewer for AP Course Review Panel , NSHE	2025
Expert Advisor , AP Research	2025 – 2026
Guest Speaker , Sky Ranch Middle School, Sparks, NV	2025
R Maven , Political Science, UCLA	2022 - 2024
Mentor , Political Science Graduate Student Mentorship Program, UCLA	2021 - 2023
Coordinator , American Politics Graduate Student Workshop, UCLA	2020 - 2021

OTHER ACTIVITIES

PCI Lab Researcher , Practical Causal Inference Lab, UCLA	2023 - present
Researcher , UCLA Health and Politics Project	2020 - 2024
Attendee , UCLA Political Psychology Lab (David Sears)	2020 - present

STUDENT ADVISING

Evan Pritsos , PhD Candidate, Dissertation Committee Member, UNR	2025 - Present
Atley Weems , MA Student, Thesis Committee Member, UNR	2025 - 2026

MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

Coverage of Research:

- The Economist, [“Why lonely Republicans are even glummer than Democrats,”](#) August 2026
- The New York Times (The Upshot), [“How Local COVID Deaths Are Affecting Vote Choice,”](#) July 2020

Subject-Matter Expert:

- Reno Gazette Journal, [“Mail ballots, high-profile races boost Nevada early voting turnout,”](#) June 2026
- The Nevada Independent, [“Ads say Aaron Ford isn’t doing enough to stop Medicaid fraud. Here’s what we found,”](#) August 2026

NON-ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center Strategic Analyst	2017 - 2019
AIDS Institute, New York State Department of Health Program Assistant	2016 - 2017

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Lynn Vavreck, Marvin Hoffenberg Professor of American Politics and Public Policy. (vavreck@mac.com)
Jeffrey Lewis, Professor of Political Science. (jblewis@polisci.ucla.edu)
Daniel Thompson, Assistant Professor of Political Science. (dthompson@polisci.ucla.edu)